

Deploying Your Site

Part of **Web Development Foundations** · Estimated time: 25 min

Introduction

A finished project sitting on your laptop isn't a website yet — deploying it means putting the files somewhere the public internet can reach, at a stable address.

Core ideas

- A build step compiles your source files (which might use tools like Sass or a framework) into plain HTML/CSS/JS that any browser can run.
- Static hosts — GitHub Pages, Netlify, Vercel — are built specifically for front-end-only sites: you push your files, and they're served from a URL within minutes, usually for free.
- A custom domain is really just a DNS record pointing a name you own (like `yoursite.com`) at your host's servers; it's a configuration step, not a rebuild.
- Your local dev server (e.g. `localhost:3000`) is only reachable from your own machine — deployment is what makes the same project reachable from anywhere.

Example

```
# A typical static deploy, using the Netlify CLI
netlify deploy --prod --dir=./build
```

Try it yourself

Take any small HTML/CSS project you've built and deploy it to a free static host of your choice. Confirm you can open the live URL from a different device (like your phone) to prove it's really public.

Further reading

- [GitHub Pages](https://pages.github.com/)

<https://pages.github.com/>

- [Vercel Documentation](https://vercel.com/docs)

<https://vercel.com/docs>

ModuloTrainer reading material — return to the app to mark this module complete.